trees native to the area. [26] As a result of all this tree planting, Central Delhi looks extraordinarily green when seen from a height (say from the Taj Hotel on Mansingh Road). Whatever one may think of the elitism of Lutyens's Delhi, it is certainly unique.

As the construction of the new city neared completion, the British raised their own pillar in front of the Viceregal palace—the Jaipur column headed by a six-point crystal star. It is easily visible through the main gate on Raisina Hill. At its base, it is inscribed: 'In thought faith/ In word wisdom/ In deed courage/ In life service/ So may India be great.' One could take these words as being patronizing or one could think of them as a premonition that colonial rule would soon end. Perhaps recognizing their own transience, the colonial rulers merely wanted later generations to think well of them. By the time New Delhi was completed in the mid-thirties, it was abundantly clear the British rule would not last too much longer.

TO CROSS THE BLACK WATERS

As we have seen, India had withdrawn into itself from the twelfth century. I have not been able to find a good explanation for why they imposed on themselves caste rules that prohibited the crossing of the seas. It is particularly puzzling since Indian merchants and princes became very wealthy from maritime trade. Brahmin scholars also benefited greatly from the demand for their services in South East Asia. It must also be added, nonetheless, that caste rules were never watertight. Indian Muslims, and even Hindus, continued to travel to foreign lands. There are remains of a large Indian trading post in far away Azerbaijan. Built in the seventeenth and eighteenth century, the Ateshgah of Baku includes the remains of a Hindu temple and inscriptions invoking the gods Ganesh and Shiva. There are also records of Indian merchants in Samarkand and Bukhara. Still, it must be admitted that these overseas outposts were a shadow of the thriving Indian networks that had once extended from China to the Middle East.

It was in the nineteenth century, under British rule, that Indians began again to travel abroad in large numbers. An important driver of migration